



NASA go water hunting

NASA's VIPER lunar rover will hunt for water on the Moon in 2022 if all goes according to plan. <https://digit.in/nov19-69>



Tesla overtakes GM

Tesla has just beaten GM to become the most valuable car company in USA, with a profit of \$1.91 per share. <https://digit.in/nov19-70>

HP Chromebook 14

Good but shy of multitasking

HP launched the Chromebook x360 in India a couple of months ago. Just a few days after that, HP launched the Chromebook 14 in India at a much more accessible price of ₹22,990. Let's see how the entry-level laptop fares.

Build and design

The cover of the Chromebook 14 is made of hard plastic, which lends the device a sturdy look but also a hollow feeling. The top cover sports a rough matte finish, which aids greatly in the user's grip over it. Opening the lid from one side reveals a good amount of panel flex.

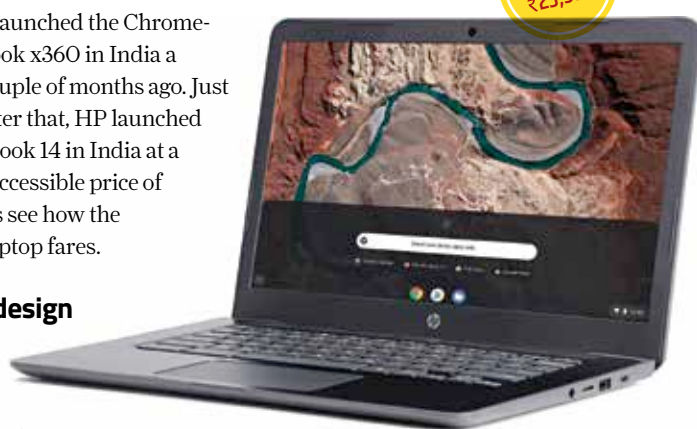
Opening the rather tight lid reveals a 14-inch touchscreen panel with a semi-glossy finish. The bezels are fairly thick, which gives the device a slightly dated look. The display hinge folds all the way back to 180 degrees, a convenience found rarely in laptops of this price range. At 1.54 kg, the device is easy to carry around.

Display, audio and IO

The display is a 14-inch WLED-backlit LCD touchscreen unit with a depressingly low resolution of 1366 x 768 pixels. Colours appear washed out and viewing angles are severely limited. Fortunately, the panel doesn't suffer from too much glare, as there's no glass surface.

The Chromebook 14 sports a Bang & Olufsen logo next to the single top-firing speaker strip. But the sound doesn't do justice to that long-standing Danish name. There's quite a bit of distortion in videos with only vocals in them.

When it comes to ports, on the left side, we see a USB-A 3.1 port and a USB-C 3.1 port along with a Kensington lock slot. On the right side, we see another



Price
₹23,990



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USB-A 3.1 port, a second USB-C 3.1 port, a microSD card slot, and a 3.5mm audio jack.

Keyboard and touchpad

The keys on the Chromebook 14 offer sufficient comfort and feedback while composing long documents.

They have decent travel but could have done with a bit more distance. The keyboard is good for everyday typing on a laptop of its price.

The touchpad on the Chromebook 14 is functional and sufficiently comfortable, but nothing to write home about. It's a decent touchpad for everyday use. The two click keys beneath the touchpad surface are fairly easy to press as well.

Performance

Our review unit came in the only configuration the device is available in: Intel Celeron N3350 Dual-core CPU, 4GB RAM, and 64GB eMMC flash storage. After a week or two with the review unit, we were mostly pleased with the performance. With the tab count not exceeding a dozen across all virtual desktops, the unit loaded each page in less than five seconds. Some heavier pages took a few seconds longer to load, but that delay can be chalked up to the low-cost Celeron chip inside. Playing videos on YouTube one at a time was no

problem but multitasking with a video playing in the background often resulted in audio stutters.

This grade of response, in our experience, is still better than that observed on other Windows 10-powered budget laptops out there in the market, including the new Lenovo IdeaPad S145.

If all you want to do is browse on Chrome lightly and watch a few videos without spending more than ₹23,000, the HP Chromebook 14 is your best bet.

When it comes to battery, the Chromebook 14 excels without a shadow of a doubt. During our everyday tests, where the screen is set to 70 percent brightness, Wi-Fi + Bluetooth are enabled, and a USB mouse is connected, the review unit consistently lost about 7-10 percent every passing hour. A full charge happened in about one and a half hours. To sum it up, the Chromebook 14 is great for anyone wanting to work away from the wall socket for about 8 or 9 hours continuously.

Bottomline

The HP Chromebook 14 truly is a game-changer in the entry-level laptop market, in that, it gives the average user the freedom to browse and perform web-only tasks with a fair amount of responsiveness when compared to other Windows 10-powered models in its price range. It even offers close to ten hours of battery life on Wi-Fi.

However, there are some drawbacks. It's not too fast and it's shy to multitask, that becomes evident the minute the tab count crosses eight or ten. It's ideal buyer is someone who needs a responsive budget laptop only for web-based activities, such as checking email, composing documents online, watching YouTube videos, etc. It is a budget laptop doesn't take an entire decade to open up just one new browser tab.

—Vignesh Giridharan

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY SIZE: 14.00-inch | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 1366x768 pixels
PROCESSOR: Celeron Dual Core | RAM: 4GB | OS: Chrome
HARD DISK: No | SSD: 16GB | WEIGHT: 2.16 kg | BLUETOOTH
VERSION: 4.2

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